

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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OUR MESSAGE:

**IT'S OUR BROKENNESS THAT ATTRACTS JESUS.
IT'S OUR VULNERABILITY THAT HE IS DRAWN TO.
IT'S OUR HUMANITY, FRAILTY AND WEAKNESSES THAT JESUS IS
CAPTIVATED BY.**

"BROKENNESS" SIGNIFIES A DEEP SENSE OF HUMILITY AND REPENTANCE BEFORE GOD, ACKNOWLEDGING ONE'S FLAWS AND NEED FOR FORGIVENESS.

BROKENNESS IN OUR LIVES ECHOES HUMILITY, GENTLENESS, TEACHABLENESS, AND A CERTAIN MEASURE OF REPENTANCE AND REMORSEFULNESS/ SORROW.

IT IS WHEN WE COME TO THE END OF OURSELVES AND THERE IS NO MORE SELF-IMPROVEMENT ATTEMPTS LEFT IN US; THAT JESUS RESPONDS TO US.

OFTEN OUR WEAKNESSES, HUMANITY, VULNERABILITY MAY REPULSE US AND CAUSE US TO DISLIKE OURSELVES AND SO WE CONTINUE TO STRUGGLE WISHING THAT WE WERE DIFFERENT OR BETTER ETC.

BUT GOD IS NOT REPULSED BY BROKENNESS, IN FACT THE OPPOSITE, HE IS DRAWN TO US IN LOVE AND COMPASSION.

BROKENNESS

IS WHEN WE ARE NO LONGER FEELING SELF-SUFFICIENT AND SAYING, "I'LL MAKE IT ON MY OWN" IT IS OUR HOPELESSNESS AND HELPLESSNESS THAT JESUS IS ATTRACTED TO.

THE SCRIPTURES DECLARE THAT GOD IS CLOSE TO THE BROKEN HEARTED AND THOSE THAT ARE CRUSHED IN SPIRIT.

Psalms 34:18 The Lord is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit. NIV

Psalms 34:18 The Lord is close to those who are of a broken heart and saves such as are crushed with sorrow for sin and are humbly and thoroughly penitent. such, O God, You will not despise. AMP

Psalms 34:18 The Lord is close to the brokenhearted; he rescues those whose spirits are crushed. NLT

Psalms 51:17 The sacrifice pleasing to God is a broken spirit. God, You will not despise a broken and humbled heart. Holman Bible

Psalms 147:3 He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds. ESV

BROKENNESS

Psalms 51:17 The sacrifice God wants is a broken spirit. God, you will not reject a heart that is broken and sorry for sin. NCV

GOD WILL NOT CAST OUT OR REJECT ALL THOSE WHO COME TO HIM

John 6:37 All whom My Father gives (entrusts) to Me will come to Me; and the one who comes to Me I will most certainly not cast out [I will never, no never, reject one of them who comes to Me]. AMP

John 6:37 All that the Father giveth me shall come to me; and him that cometh to me I will in no wise cast out. KJV

John 6:37 Whoever comes to me I will never drive away. NIV

JESUS WAS A FRIEND OF TAX COLLECTORS, SINNERS AND OUTCASTS OF SOCIETY!'

Matthew 11:19 The Son of Man "a friend of tax collectors and sinners" Holman - Matthew 11:19 TEV

GOD ANOINTED JESUS TO HEAL THE BROKEN HEARTED ETC.

*Luke 4:18 The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he hath anointed me to preach the gospel to the poor; **he hath sent me to heal the brokenhearted**, to preach deliverance to the captives, and recovering of sight to the blind, to set at liberty them that are bruised, KJV & TLB*

JESUS IS NOT REPULSED BY THE BROKENNESS OF PEOPLE'S LIVES – HE IS ATTRACTED TO THEM.

EXAMPLE:

THE SAMARITAN WOMEN AT THE WELL – John 4

This woman had been married 5 times and 5 times divorced and now living with another man and not married.

BUT JESUS WAS NOT REPULSED BY THE BROKENNESS OF HER LIFE. He did not reject or cast her out or disassociate himself from her.

IT WAS HER BROKENNESS AND MESSED UP STATE OF LIFE THAT ATTRACTED HIM AND HE SAVED AND FORGAVE HER.

Jesus said *"If you only knew what a wonderful gift God has for you John 4:10, TLB John 4:16-17*

16 "Go and get your husband," Jesus told her.

17-18 "But I'm not married," the woman replied. "All too true!" Jesus said. "For you have had five husbands, and you aren't even married to the man you're living with now." TLB

EXAMPLE:

THEN THERE WAS THE WOMEN TAKEN IN ADULTERY

She is about to be publicly stoned to death.

John 8:4 and said to Jesus, "Teacher, this woman was caught in the act of adultery.

7 "If any one of you is without sin, let him be the first to throw a stone at her."

9 At this, those who heard began to go away one at a time, the older ones first, until only Jesus was left, with the woman still standing there.

10 Jesus straightened up and asked her, "Woman, where are they? Has no one condemned you?"

11 "No one, sir," she said. "Then neither do I condemn you," Jesus declared. "Go now and leave your life of sin." NIV

In this case Jesus did not "wink his eye", overlook or condone adultery BUT IT WAS IN HER BROKENNESS AND VULNERABILITY OF A DAMAGED LIFE THAT ATTRACTED JESUS TO SHOW KINDNESS AND FORGIVENESS.

JESUS SHOWS MERCY TO THE SINNER, TO THOSE WHO ARE BROKEN AND 'MESSED UP' IN LIFE. HE SAID; **IT IS THE SICK THAT NEED A DOCTOR.**

AND THIS IS THE REASON HE CAME

Matthew 9:11-13

11 But when the Pharisees saw this, they asked his disciples, "Why does your teacher eat with such scum?"

12 When Jesus heard this, he said, "Healthy people don't need a doctor—sick people do."

*13 Then he added, "Now go and learn the meaning of this Scripture: '**I want you to show mercy**, not offer sacrifices.' **For I have come** to call not those who think they are righteous, but those who know they are sinners." NLT*

JESUS SAID HE WANTS US TO SHOW MERCY ALSO.

Amen – Ps Barry